Proposals for the post of

General Secretary Social and Cultural

Technology Students' Gymkhana

Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur

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INTRODUCTION OF OPEN IIT IMPROV BATTLE

GENERAL SECRETARY SOCIAL AND CULTURAL

PROPOSALS

Proposal 1 – INTRODUCTION OF FRESHER'S CULTURAL NIGHT

Objective:

The Freshers' Cultural Night aims to provide first-year students with an open and encouraging platform to explore their interests and identify their strengths across various social and cultural domains. It will act as a low-pressure entry point into the institute's cultural ecosystem.

Impact:

• Enables freshers to discover their strengths and interests in domains like music, dance, dramatics, and literary arts.

• Increases early-stage participation in societies, Open IIT, and GC Social and Cultural.

• Builds confidence and encourages long-term cultural engagement in campus.

Implementation:

• Organize a dedicated Cultural Night exclusively for freshers after induction program featuring events such as singing, dancing, open mic, stand-up, and informal performances.

• Include a shortlisting process through online video submissions to ensure smooth event flow.

• Ensure a healthy participation, supportive environment with constructive feedback from freshers.

Format:

• Preliminary Round (Online): Freshers submit short performance videos; basic screening done by social and cultural societies.

• Final Night (Offline): Selected participants depending on registrations perform live in the venue in front of peers and judges.

• Judges provide brief insights to help participants understand their strengths and areas of improvement.

Groundwork:

• Venue booking and coordination with administration.

• Release of participation forms and management of online video submissions.

• Collaboration with cultural societies to serve as judges and mentors.

• Coordination with AV Cell for sound, lighting, and recording.

• Arrangement of basic logistics including refreshments and stage setup.

Proposal 2 – CULTURAL WORKSHOPS FOR POSTGRADUATE & RESEARCH SCHOLARS

Objective:

Participation from Postgraduate and Research Scholar communities in cultural activities has traditionally remained limited, largely due to the absence of structured and accessible platforms aligned with their schedules. Introducing workshops provides a more flexible way of illuminating a will to participate in cultural activities, to ones who are interested and finding balance beyond academics.

Implementation:

• Organize short, beginner-friendly cultural workshops exclusively for Postgraduate and Research students across domains like music, dance, theatre, and informal arts.

• Conduct sessions during convenient time slots (weekends or post-lab hours) with minimal commitment requirements.

• Collaborate with societies for targeted outreach and ensure a low-pressure environment with likeminded peers around them.

Impact:

• Increased participation of Postgraduate and Research Scholars students in cultural activities and gradual involvement in Inter IIT and General Championship Social and Cultural.

• Improved inclusivity and skill development, leading to stronger integration of Postgraduates and Research Scholars communities into campus cultural life.

Groundwork:

• Finalize suitable time slots (weekends/evenings) considering academic and lab schedules of Postgraduate and Research students.

• Arrange accessible venues across campus with basic infrastructure for conducting workshops.

• Coordinating with societies and Postgraduate and Research Scholar Coordinators to ensure smooth execution and participation.

Proposal 3 – CULTURAL KNOWLEDGE & RESOURCE PORTAL

Objective:

Preparation for Inter IIT and other major cultural events often lacks continuity, as valuable insights and resources from previous years remain scattered or undocumented. This leads to repeated effort, inefficiencies, and loss of institutional learning over time. Establishing a structured and centralized repository would streamline preparation, reduce redundancy, and improve overall efficiency. It would also help enabling teams to learn from past experiences, building strong institutional memory and achieve consistently better performances over the years.

Implementation:

• Develop a dedicated platform under the Gymkhana hosting past performances (videos, scripts, compositions), choreography breakdowns, judging insights, and preparation timelines.

• Structure the content domain-wise (dance, music, dramatics, etc.) and mandate post-event documentation from teams to ensure regular updates.

Impact:

• Streamlined preparation with reduced redundancy and improved outcomes.

• Creation of strong institutional memory, leading to consistently better performances over the years.

Groundwork:

• Coordinate with Tech coordinators and web secretaries for platform development and maintenance.

• Integrate existing content from social media platforms and archival sources.

• Collaborate with societies and past participants to collect and organize relevant data.

Proposal 4 – INTRODUCTION OF OPEN IIT IMPROV BATTLE

Objective:

There is currently limited representation of improvisational arts such as spontaneous acting and quick-thinking performance formats within the cultural ecosystem. Introducing an improv-based event would provide a unique platform for creativity and on-the-spot expression, attracting a new segment of participants. This would help the interested candidates to showcase their talents later on, in the inter IIT improv battle.

Implementation:

• Organize an Open IIT Improv Battle open to all students, featuring formats like situational acting, prompt-based performances, and team improv rounds.

• Conduct a short pre-event workshop to introduce participants to basics of improvisation and stage presence.

Format:

The event will be conducted over two days:

Day 1 – Prelims (Showcase & Basics Round)

Each participant/team gets 2–3 minutes to perform short improv acts based on given prompts or situations.

Judges will evaluate spontaneity, creativity, and ability to build meaningful scenes on the spot.

The top participants/teams will be selected for the final knockout rounds and will be seeded for the next day's battles.

Day 2 – Finals (Improv Battle Rounds)

The Top participants/teams will go head-to-head in knockout improv battles.

Each battle will consist of 2–3 rounds involving different formats such as situational acting, word prompts, character switches, or audience suggestions.

Participants will be given limited preparation time (30–60 seconds) before each round.

The winner advances through successive rounds until the final battle determines the Open IIT Improv Champion.

Judging Criteria:

Spontaneity & Wit: Ability to think quickly and respond naturally in unexpected situations.

Creativity & Originality: Uniqueness in ideas, characters, and storytelling.

Execution & Collaboration: Smooth scene-building, coherence, and interaction.

Stage Presence & Engagement: Confidence, energy, and ability to captivate both judges and audience.

Impact:

• Encourages participation from students who may not engage in traditional cultural formats.

• Enhances skills like creativity, confidence, communication, and spontaneity.

• Diversifies the cultural landscape and strengthens dramatics representation in competitions.

Groundwork:

• Coordinate with Technology Comedy Club and Dramatics Societies for event design and execution.

• Arrange suitable indoor venue with minimal stage setup.

• Promote widely to ensure participation from diverse student groups.